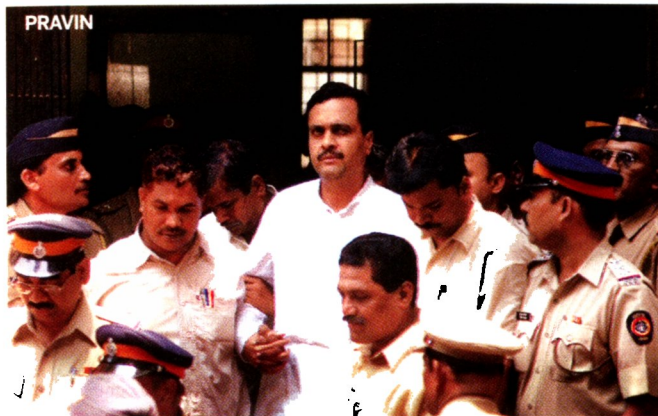


MUMBAI | Prison Diary

FAWZAN HUSAIN



A year after being convicted for life for killing his brother Pramod Mahajan, Pravin has come out with a tell-all book on his family, particularly his slain brother. Titled *My Album*, the book "is a documentary on my life playing out in front of my eyes as I sit in jail," writes Pravin. Revealing the dark side of Pramod, one of Maharashtra's most powerful politicians, Pravin accuses him of "being affected because of his passion for women and money". He alleges that his brother's associations with

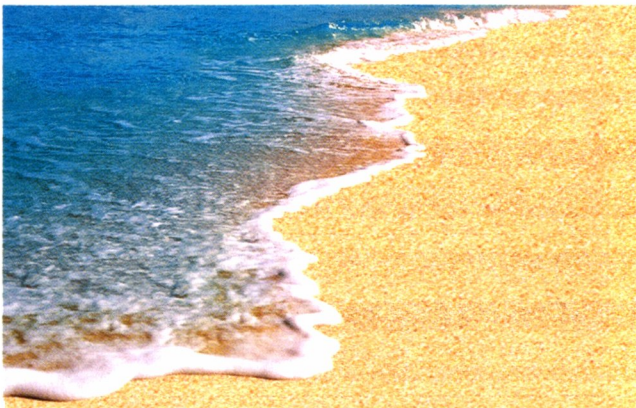
women had led his wife Rekha to urge senior BJP leaders to intervene. She had even threatened to divorce him, the book claims. The contents have seen the Mahajan family members deny the allegations and emphasise that this is no more than a political conspiracy ahead of the elections. Oddly enough, Pravin also describes his brother as a "pillar of strength" and how he nurtured the family after their father's death. "He was the hero of our family," says the book.

by Aditi Pal

KOLKATA | Coffee Couture

A glossy makeover of a coffee shop isn't good enough for Bengali intellectuals. The Indian Coffee House on the College Street has undergone a renovation, an initiative of Samar Nag, head of Bengal Shelter, a cultural corporate. While old-timers miss the sooty walls, the crumbling staircase and political posters, Governor Gopal Krishna Gandhi gave the makeover a stamp of approval in his own unique way when he came over to have a cuppa to mark the 50th year of one of the most popular cultural institutions of the Bengali intelligentsia with a *jhola* and Charminar cigarettes. The gathering also included a number of top-notch poets, writers and other celebrities.

by Abhijit Dasgupta



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